> Afzal ke haath aur taang kaat ke, road mein bheek mangvani chahiye. (Cut off his arms and legs and make him beg on the streets.)

Then in English:

> Hang him by his balls in Lal Chowk. Hang him and hang those who are supporting him.

Even without Sharia courts, we seem to be doing just fine.

For the record, the reporter Neeta Sharma, credited several times on the programme for procuring the video, has been previously exposed for publishing falsehoods: on the 'encounter' in Ansal Plaza;[19] on the Iftikhar Gilani case;[20] on the S.A.R. Geelani case; and now on this one. Neeta Sharma was formerly a reporter with the *Hindustan Times*. Publishing Special Cell handouts seems to have got her a promotion—from print journalism to TV.

This kind of thing really makes you wonder whether media houses have an inside track on the police and intelligence agencies, or whether it's the other way around.

The quietest guest on the panel was M.K. Dhar, a former Joint Director of the Intelligence Bureau. He was pretty enigmatic. He certainly didn't repeat what he has said in his astonishingly frank book *Open Secrets: India's Intelligence Unveiled*: 'Some day or the other, taking advantage of the weakening fabric of our democracy, some unscrupulous intelligence men may gang up with ambitious Army brass and change the political texture of the nation.'[21]

Weakening fabric of our democracy. I couldn't have put it better.

"On 13 December 2006, the families, accompanied by M.S. Bitta, returned the bravery medals after a meeting with President A.P.J. Abdul Kalam.

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